

Embedded Systems with ARM Cortex-M Microcontrollers in Assembly Language and C

Chapter 5 Memory Access



Z. Gu



Fall 2025

Overview

- ▶ How data is organized in memory?
 - ▶ Big-Endian vs Little-Endian
- ▶ How data is addressed?
 - ▶ Register offset
 - ▶ `LDR r1, [r0, r3]` ; offset = r3
 - ▶ `LDR r1, [r0, r3, LSL #2]` ; offset = r3 * 4
 - ▶ Immediate offset
 - ▶ Pre-index: `LDR r1, [r0, #4]`
 - ▶ Post-index: `LDR r1, [r0], #4`
 - ▶ Pre-index with update: `LDR r1, [r0, #4]!`

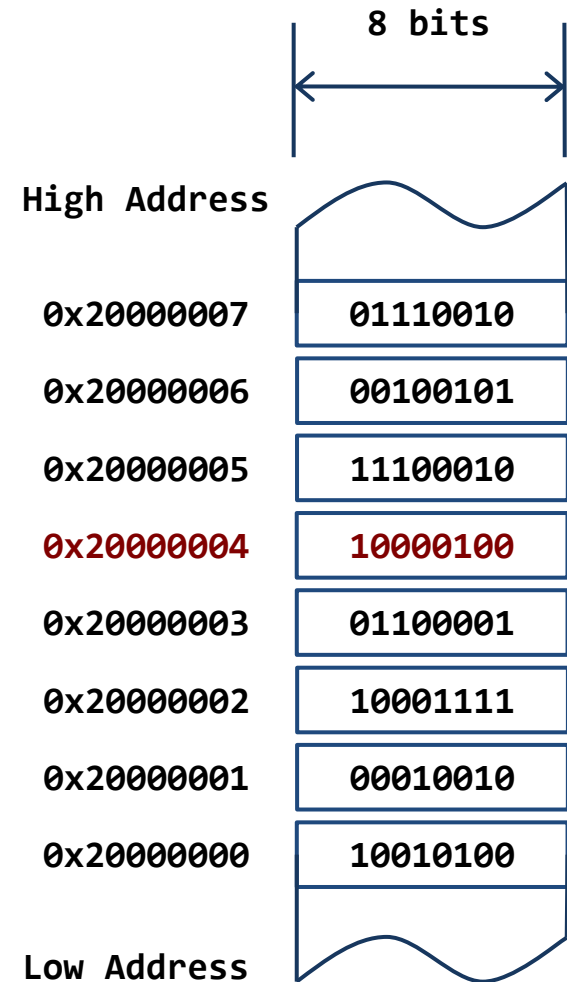
Logic View of Memory

- ▶ By grouping bits together we can store more values
 - ▶ 8 bits = **1 byte**
 - ▶ 16 bits = 2 bytes = **1 halfword**
 - ▶ 32 bits = 4 bytes = **1 word**
- ▶ From software perspective, memory is an addressable array of bytes.

0b10000100 → 0x84 → 132

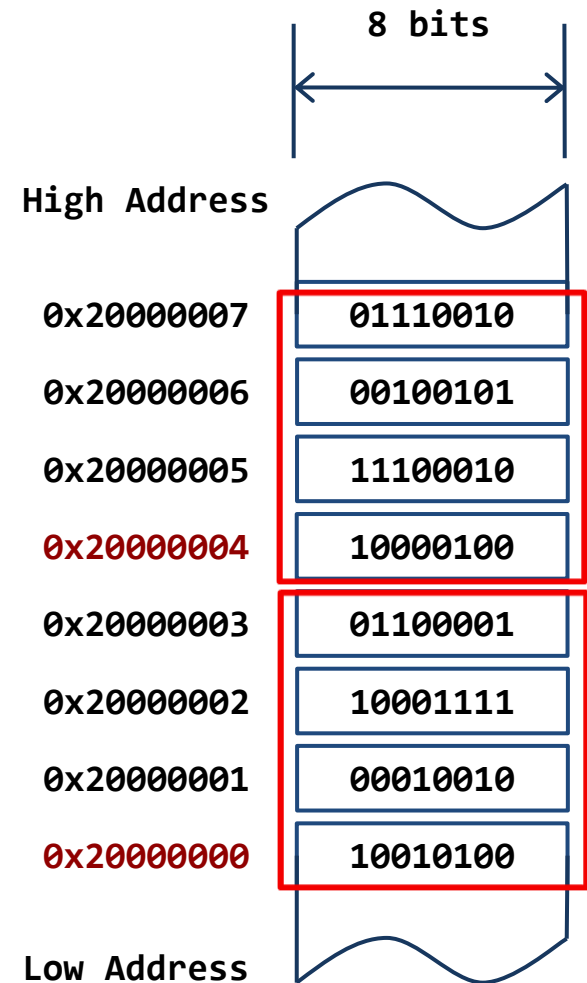
Binary Hexadecimal Decimal

Computer memory is *byte-addressable*!



Logic View of Memory

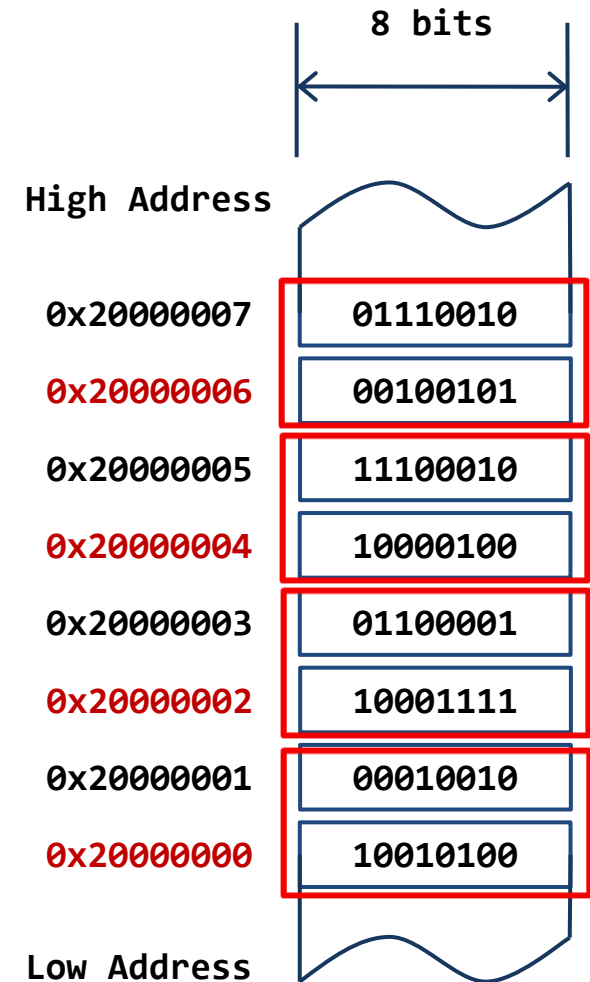
- ▶ When we refer to memory locations by address, we can only do so in units of bytes, halfwords or words
- ▶ Architecturally aligned addresses are required for efficient access; unaligned access may require multiple cycles
 - ▶ A word should be stored at an address that's divisible by 4 (Word-address mod 4 = 0, binary address ends with 00)
 - ▶ Memory address of a word is the lowest address of all four bytes in that word.
 - ▶ Two words at addresses: 0x20000000 and 0x20000004
 - ▶ A halfword should be stored at an address that's divisible by 2 (Halfword-address mod 2 = 0, binary address ends with 0)
 - ▶ Memory address of a halfword is the lowest address of all 2 bytes in that word.



Logic View of Memory

▶ Halfwords

- ▶ **16 bits = 2 bytes = 1 halfword**
- ▶ The right diagram has four halfwords at addresses of:
 - ▶ 0x20000000
 - ▶ 0x20000002
 - ▶ 0x20000004
 - ▶ 0x20000006



Data Alignment and Performance

- Assume a byte-addressable memory with a data bus that is 32 bits (4 bytes) wide
- Consider 16 bytes of memory (addresses 0 to 15) arranged as four 32-bit words (4 bytes each)

Address 15	Address 14	Address 13	Address 12
Address 11	Address 10	Address 9	Address 8
Address 7 (MSbyte)	Address 6	Address 5	Address 4 (LSbyte)
Address 3	Address 2	Address 1	Address 0

Well-aligned: each word begins on a mod-4 address, which can be read in a single memory cycle

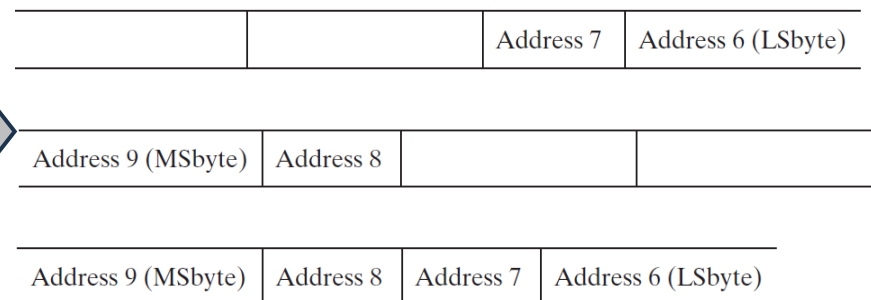
Address 15	Address 14	Address 13	Address 12
Address 11	Address 10	Address 9 (MSbyte)	Address 8
Address 7	Address 6 (LSbyte)	Address 5	Address 4
Address 3	Address 2	Address 1	Address 0

Ill-aligned: a word begins on address 6, not a mod-4 address, which can be read in 2 memory cycles

The first read cycle would retrieve 4 bytes from addresses 4 through 7; of these, the bytes from addresses 4 and 5 are discarded, and those from addresses 6 and 7 are moved to the far right;

The second read cycle retrieves 4 bytes from addresses 8 through 11; the bytes from addresses 10 and 11 are discarded, and those from addresses 8 and 9 are moved to the far left;

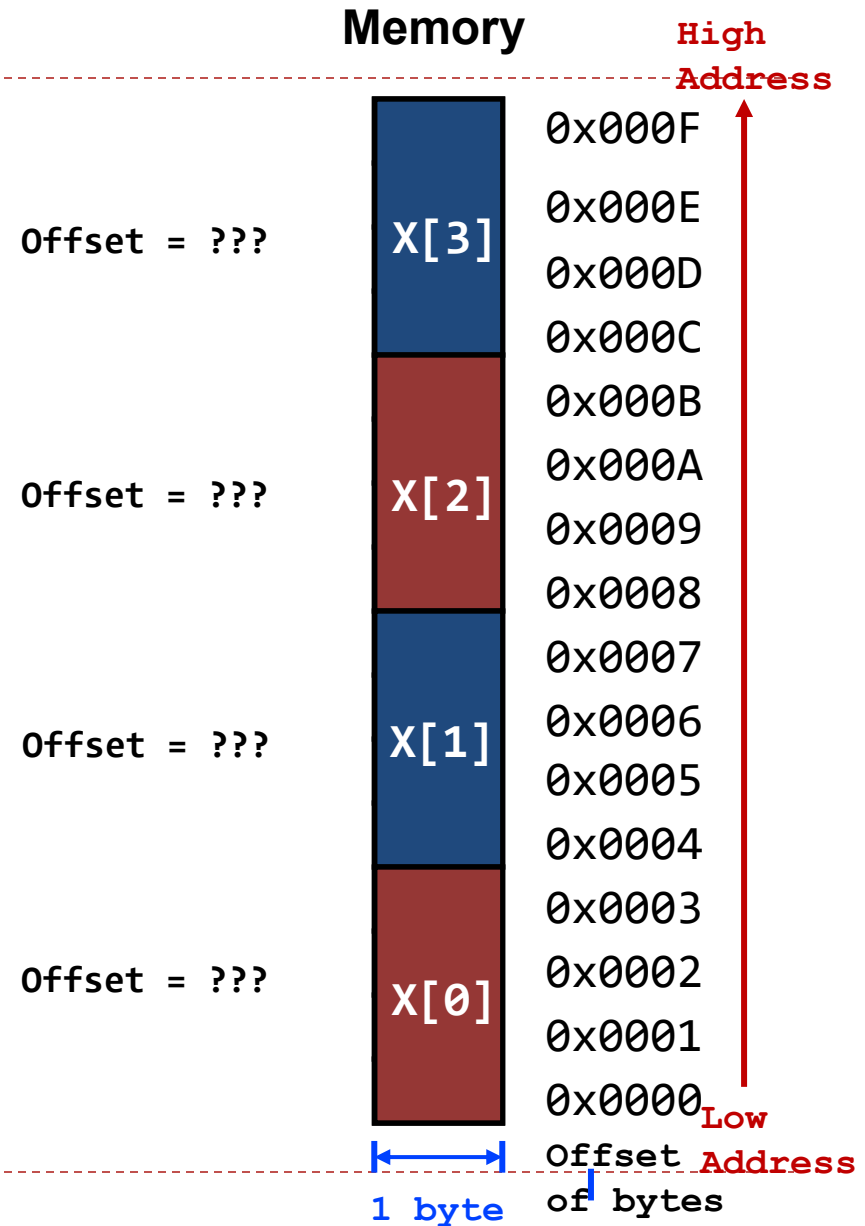
Finally, the two halves are combined to form the desired 32-bit operand.



Quiz

```
uint32_t X[4];
```

What are their memory address offsets?



Quiz ANS

`uint32_t X[4];`

What are their memory address offsets?

If the array starts at address `pAddr = 0x0000`, Offset = 4

- Memory address of `X[0]` is `pAddr = 0x0000`
- Memory address of `X[1]` is `pAddr + 4 = 0x0004`
- Memory address of `X[2]` is `pAddr + 8 = 0x0008`
- Memory address of `X[3]` is `pAddr + 12 = 0x000C`

Sequential words are at addresses incrementing by 4, since each array element of type `uint32_t` is 4 bytes (32 bits)

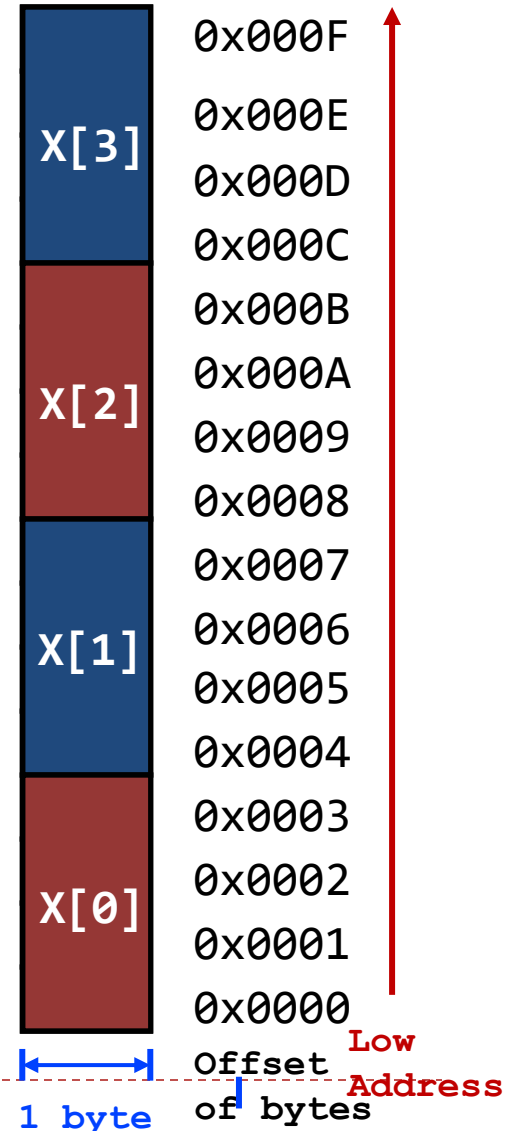
Memory

High Address

Offset = 12

Offset = 8

Offset = 0



Endianess



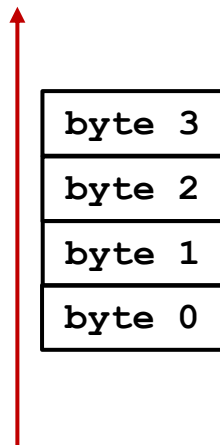
Gulliver's Travels (by Jonathan Swift, published in 1726):

- Two religious sects of Lilliputians
- The Little-Endians crack open their eggs from the little end
- The Big-Endians break their on the big end

Endianess

Endian: byte order, not bit order!

High address



Low address



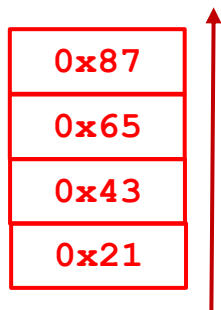
LSB is at
lower address



MSB is at
lower address

Little-Endian

High address

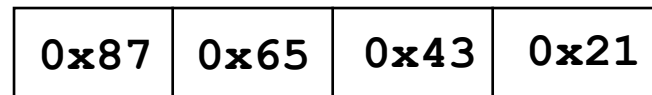


Low address

`uint32_t a = 0x87654321`

Reading from the top

byte 3 byte 2 byte 1 byte 0

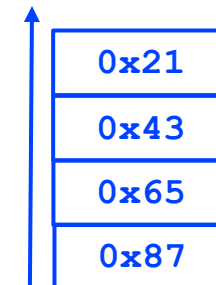


byte 0 byte 1 byte 2 byte 3

Reading from the bottom

Big-Endian

High address

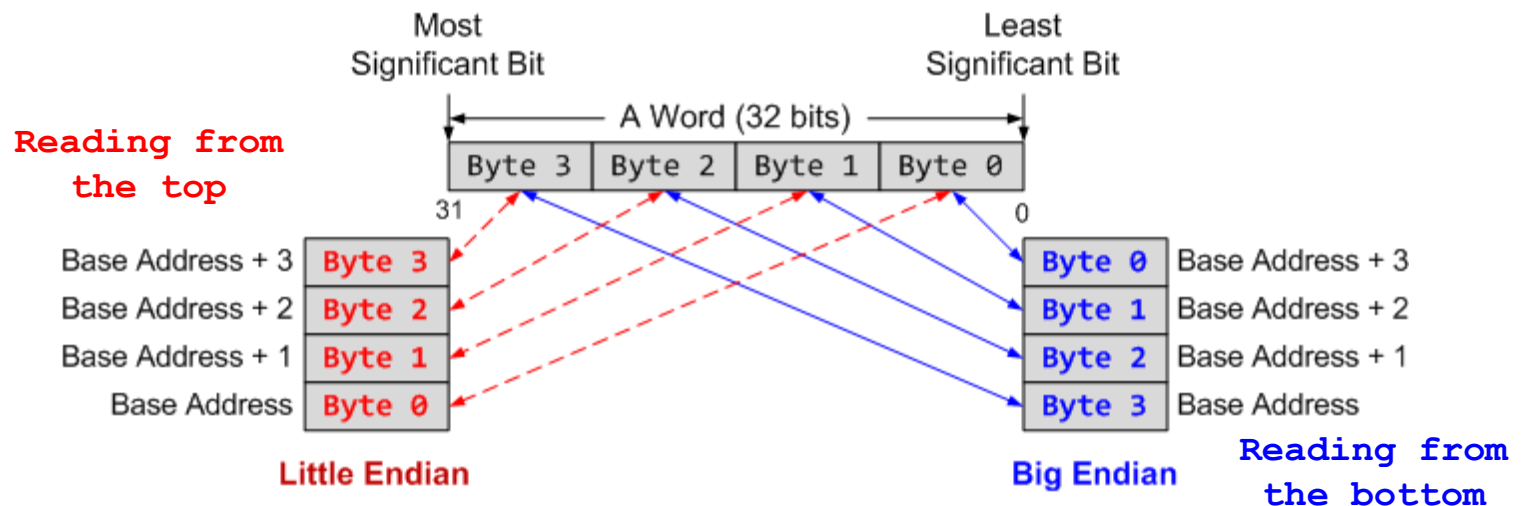


Low address



Endianess

- ▶ **Little-Endian**
 - ▶ Least significant byte (LSB) is stored at lowest (least) address of a word
- ▶ **Big-Endian**
 - ▶ Most significant byte (MSB) is stored at lowest (least) address of a word
- ▶ Regardless of endianness, the address of a word is defined as the lowest address of all bytes it occupies.
- ▶ ARM is *Little-Endian by default*.
 - ▶ It can be made Big-Endian by configuration.



Endianness Example

▶ Little-Endian

▶ LSB is at lower address

	Memory Offset	Value (LSB) (MSB)
<code>uint8_t a = 1;</code>	0x0000	01 02 FF 00
<code>uint8_t b = 2;</code>		
<code>uint16_t c = 255; // 0x00FF</code>		
<code>uint32_t d = 0x12345678;</code>	0x0004	78 56 34 12

• Big-Endian

– MSB is at lower address

	Memory Offset	Value (LSB) (MSB)
<code>uint8_t a = 1;</code>	0x0000	01 02 00 FF
<code>uint8_t b = 2;</code>		
<code>uint16_t c = 255; // 0x00FF</code>		
<code>uint32_t d = 0x12345678;</code>	0x0004	12 34 56 78

- For `uint8_t` `a` and `b`, each with size of 1 Byte: No difference
- **Little-endian:**
 - For `uint16_t` `c` with size of 2 Bytes: LSB FF is at lower address and MSB 00 is at higher address
 - For `uint32_t` `d` with size of 4 Bytes: LSB 78 is at lower address and MSB 12 is at higher address.
- **Big-endian:**
 - For `uint16_t` `c` with size of 2 Bytes: LSB FF is at **higher** address and MSB 00 is at **lower** address
 - For `uint32_t` `d` with size of 4 Bytes: LSB 78 is at **higher** address and MSB 12 is at **lower** address.

Example

If Big-Endian is used, the word stored at address 0x20008000 is

If Little-Endian is used, the word stored at address 0x20008000 is

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008003	0xA7
0x20008002	0x90
0x20008001	0x8C
0x20008000	0xEE

Example

If Big-Endian is used, the word stored at address 0x20008000 is

0xEE8C90A7

If Little-Endian is used, the word stored at address 0x20008000 is

0xA7908CEE

Endianness specifies byte order, not bit order in a byte!

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008003	0xA7
0x20008002	0x90
0x20008001	0x8C
0x20008000	0xEE

Load-Modify-Store

C statement

X = X + 1;



Assume variable X resides in memory and is a 32-bit integer

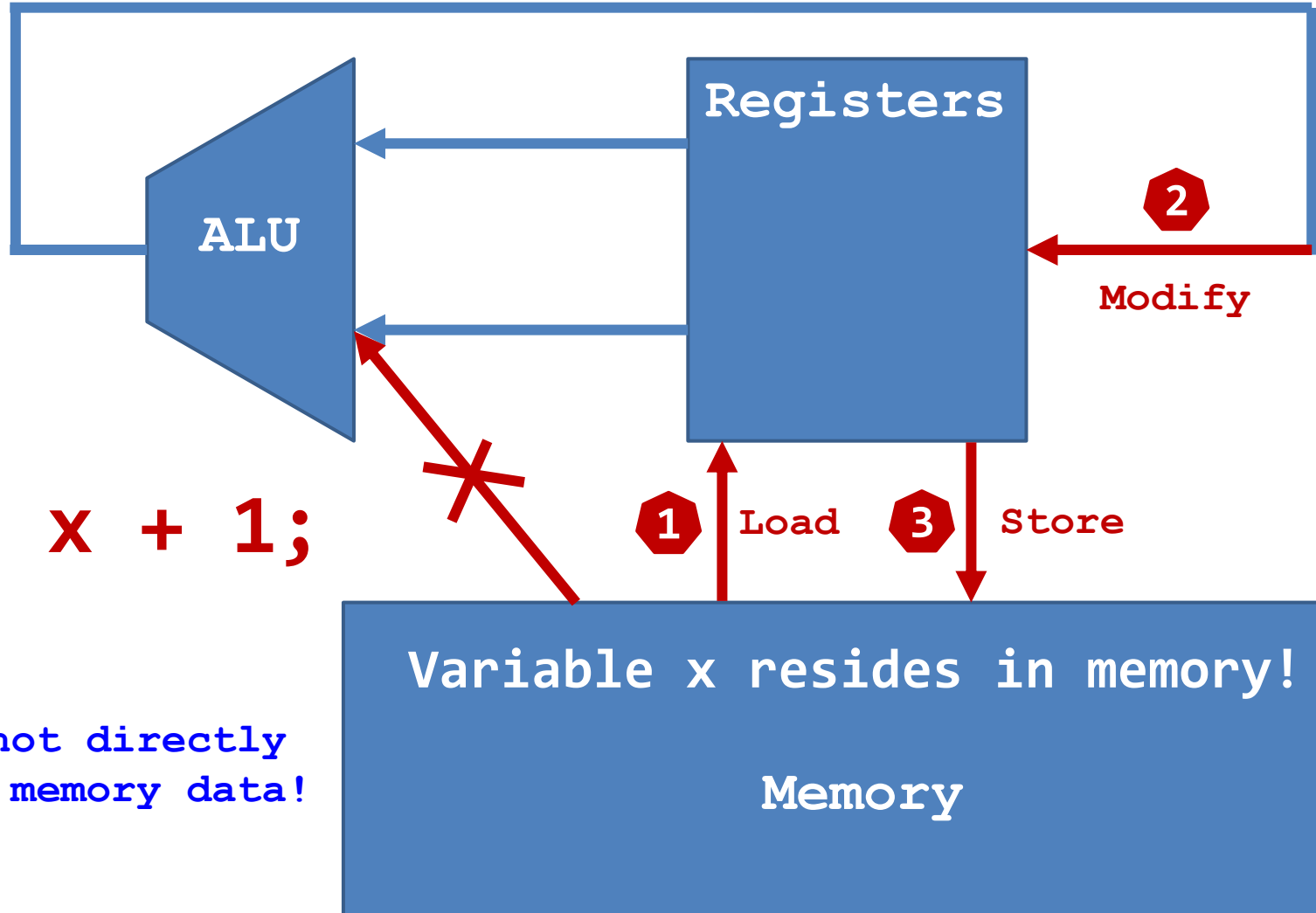
; Assume the memory address of x is stored in r1

LDR r0, [r1] ; load value of x from memory

ADD r0, r0, #1 ; x = x + 1

STR r0, [r1] ; store x into memory

3 Steps: Load, Modify, Store



$X = X + 1;$

ALU cannot directly
operate memory data!

Load Instructions

▶ **LDR rt, [rs]**

▶ **Read from memory**

▶ Mnemonic: LoaD to Register (**LDR**)

▶ rs specifies the memory address

▶ rt holds the 32-bit value fetched from memory

▶ For Example:

; Assume r0 = 0x08200004

; Load a word:

LDR r1, [r0]

; r1 = Memory.word[0x08200004]

Store Instructions

- ▶ **STR rt, [rs]**

- ▶ **Write into memory**

- ▶ Mnemonic: STore from Register (**STR**)

- ▶ rs specifies memory address

- ▶ Save the content of rt into memory

- ▶ For Example:

- ; Assume r0 = 0x08200004

- ; Store a word

- STR r1, [r0]** ; Memory.word[0x08200004] = r1

Load/Store a Byte, Halfword, Word

LDRxxx R0, [R1]

; Load data from memory into a **32-bit** register

LDR	Load Word	uint32_t/int32_t	unsigned or signed int
LDRB	Load B yte	uint8_t	unsigned char
LDRH	Load H alfword	uint16_t	unsigned short int
LDRSB	Load S igned B yte	int8_t	signed char
LDRSH	Load S igned H alfword	int16_t	signed short int

STRxxx R0, [R1]

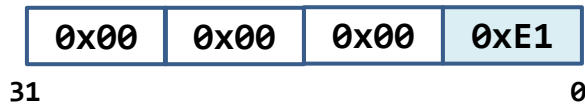
; Store data extracted from a **32-bit** register into memory

STR	Store Word	uint32_t/int32_t	unsigned or signed int
STRB	Store Lower B yte	uint8_t/int8_t	unsigned or signed char
STRH	Store Lower H alfword	uint16_t/int16_t	unsigned or signed short

Load a Byte, Half-word, Word (Little-Endian)

Load a Byte

LDRB r1, [r0]



0x02000003	0x87
0x02000002	0x65
0x02000001	0xE3
0x02000000	0xE1

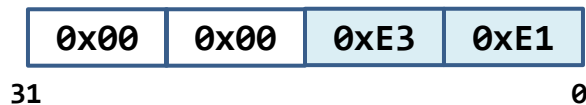
Little-Endian

Assume

r0 = 0x02000000

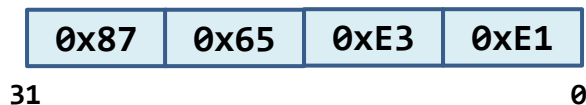
Load a Halfword

LDRH r1, [r0]



Load a Word

LDR r1, [r0]



LDRH "Load Register Halfword": it loads a 16-bit halfword value from the memory address pointed to by register r0 into register r1. The loaded 16-bit value is **zero-extended** to fill the 32-bit register r1. This means the upper 16 bits of r1 will be set to zero regardless of the halfword data.

LDRB "Load Register Byte": it loads 8-bit byte value from the memory address pointed to by register r0 into register r1, and **zero-extends** it.

Sign Extension (Little-Endian)

Load a Signed Byte

LDRSB r1, [r0]



Load a Signed Halfword

LDRSH r1, [r0]



0x20000003	0x87
0x20000002	0x65
0x20000001	0xE3
0x20000000	0xE1

Little-Endian

Assume

r0 = 0x02000000

LDRSH "Load Register Signed Halfword"
LDRSB "Load Register Signed Byte"
Similar to LDRH and LDRB, except each **sign-extends** the value to fill the 32-bit register, not zero-extend. Facilitate subsequent 32-bit signed arithmetic.

Address Modes: Offset in Register

- ▶ Address accessed by **LDR/STR** is specified by a base register **plus an offset**
- ▶ Offset can be held in **a register**

LDR r0, [r1, r2]

- ▶ Base memory address held in register r1
- ▶ Offset held r2
- ▶ Target address = $r1 + r2$

LDR r0, [r1, r2, LSL #2]

- ▶ Base memory address held in register r1
- ▶ Offset = $r2, \text{LSL } \#2$
- ▶ Target address = $r1 + r2 * 4$

Address Modes: Immediate Offset

- ▶ Address accessed by **LDR/STR** is specified by a base register **plus an offset**
- ▶ Offset can be **an immediate value**

LDR r0, [r1, #8]

- ▶ Base memory address hold in register r1
- ▶ Offset is an immediate value
- ▶ Target address = $r1 + 8$

Three modes for immediate offset:

- Pre-index,
- Post-index,
- Pre-index with Update

Addressing Mode: Pre-index *vs* Post-index

- ▶ Pre-index

LDR r1, [r0, Offset]

- ▶ Post-index

LDR r1, [r0], Offset

- ▶ Pre-index with Update

LDR r1, [r0, Offset]!

The table assumes r0 = 0x100, offset = 4 bytes (#4)

Mode	Address used for Load	Base register update	Example (r0=0x100)
Pre-index LDR r1, [r0, #4]	r0 + offset (0x104)	No	r1 = data[0x104]; r0 = 0x100
Post-index LDR r1, [r0], #4	r0 (0x100)	Yes, after load	r1 = data[0x100]; r0 = 0x104
Pre-index w/ Update LDR r1, [r0, #4]!	r0 + offset (0x104)	Yes, before load	r1 = data[0x104]; r0 = 0x104

Pre-index

Pre-Index: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x88
0x20008006	0x79
0x20008005	0x6A
0x20008004	0x5B
0x20008003	0x4C
0x20008002	0x3D
0x20008001	0x2E
0x20008000	0x1F

- Calculates address by adding the offset (here, #4) to the base register (r0) before the load. Loads data from the resulting address r0+4 into r1. The base register (r0) is not updated.
- Example: instruction accesses memory at r0 + 4 = 0x20008004, but r0 remains to be 0x20008000 after execution.

Pre-index

Pre-Index: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x88
0x20008006	0x79
0x20008005	0x6A
0x20008004	0x5B
0x20008003	0x4C
0x20008002	0x3D
0x20008001	0x2E
0x20008000	0x1F

r0 0x20008000 → 0x20008000

Pre-index

Pre-Index: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255

		Memory Address	Memory Data
		0x20008007	0x88
		0x20008006	0x79
		0x20008005	0x6A
		0x20008004	0x5B
		0x20008003	0x4C
		0x20008002	0x3D
		0x20008001	0x2E
		0x20008000	0x1F

$r0 + \text{offset}$

offset=4

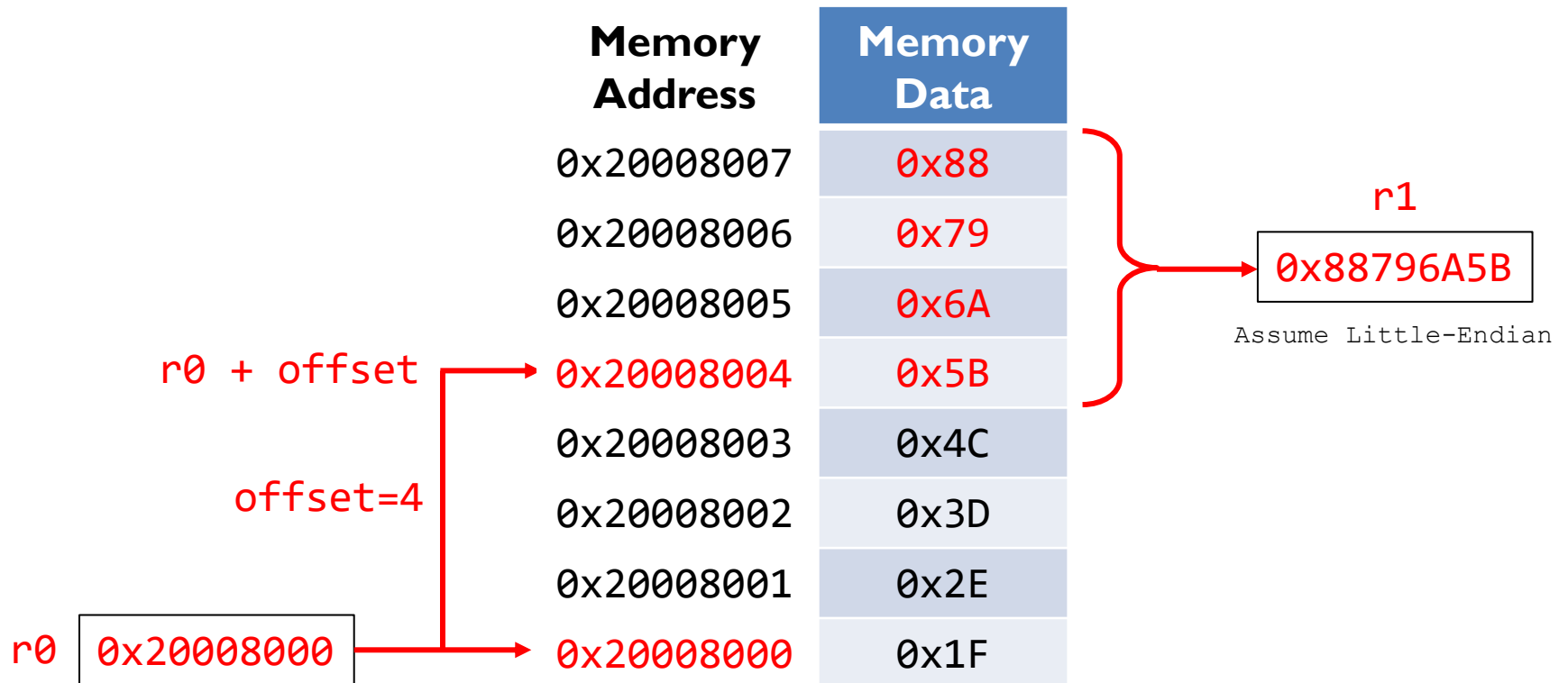
r0 0x20008000 → 0x20008000

Pre-index

Pre-Index: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255



Accessing an Array

► C code

```
uint32_t array[10];  
array[0] += 5;  
array[1] += 5;
```

Assume the memory address of the array starts at 0x20008000.

► Pre-index

Assume r0 = 0x20008000.

```
LDR r1, [r0]      ; Read array[0]  
ADD r1, r1, #5  
STR r1, [r0]      ; Write to array[0]  
  
LDR r1, [r0, #4]  ; Read array[1]  
ADD r1, r1, #5  
STR r1, [r0, #4]  ; Write to array[1]
```

Post-index

Post-Index: **LDR r1, [r0], #4**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x88
0x20008006	0x79
0x20008005	0x6A
0x20008004	0x5B
0x20008003	0x4C
0x20008002	0x3D
0x20008001	0x2E
0x20008000	0x1F

- Loads data from the address currently in r0 into r1. After the load, updates the base register (r0) by adding the offset (#4).
- Example: instruction accesses memory at r0 = 0x20008000, then increments r0 by the offset of 4 to r0 + 4 = 0x20008004 after execution.

Post-index

Post-Index: **LDR r1, [r0], #4**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255

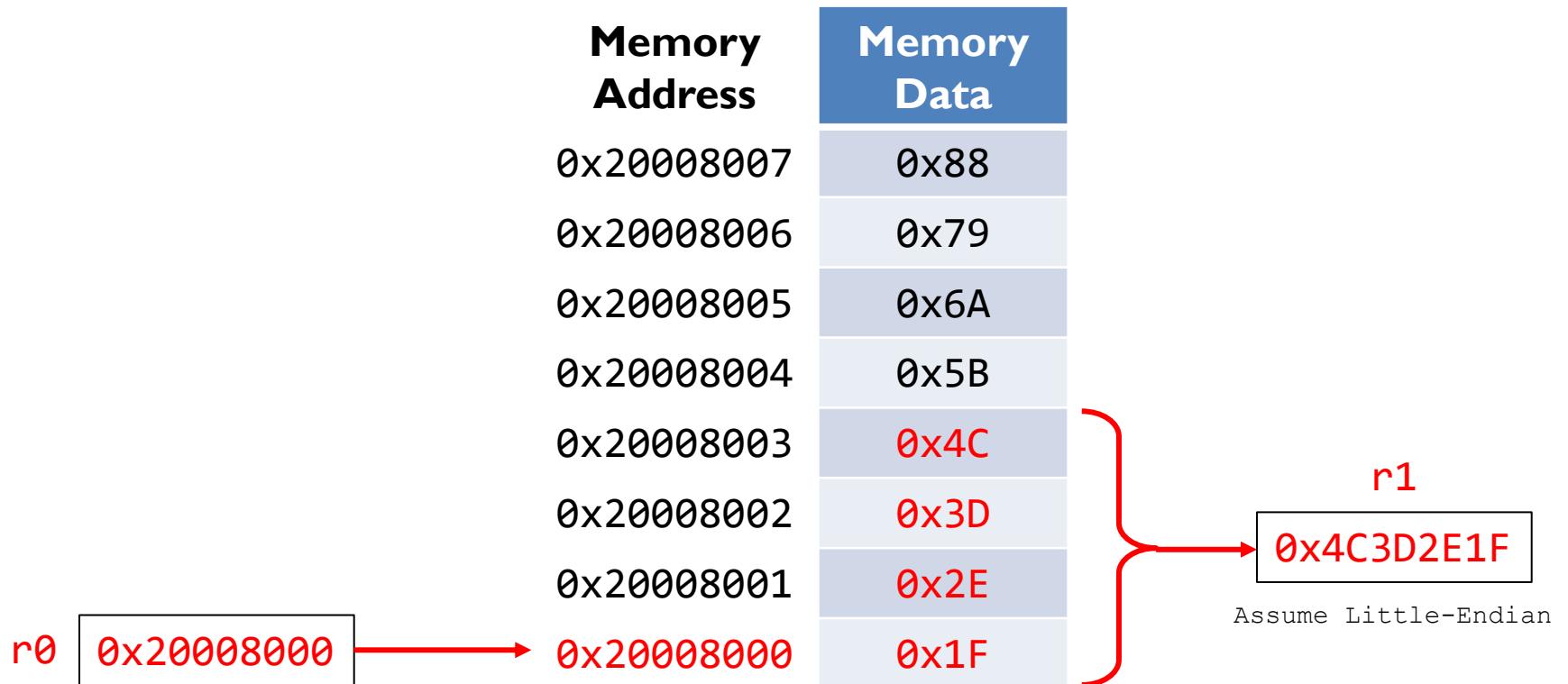
Memory Address		Memory Data
0x20008007		0x88
0x20008006		0x79
0x20008005		0x6A
0x20008004		0x5B
0x20008003		0x4C
0x20008002		0x3D
0x20008001		0x2E
r0 0x20008000	→	0x20008000 0x1F

Pre-index

Pre-Index: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255



Pre-index

Pre-Index: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is -255 to +255

Update r0 after
reading memory

$r0 = r0 + \text{offset}$

r0 0x20008004

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x88
0x20008006	0x79
0x20008005	0x6A
0x20008004	0x5B
0x20008003	0x4C
0x20008002	0x3D
0x20008001	0x2E
0x20008000	0x1F

r1
0x4C3D2E1F

Assume Little-Endian

Pre-index with Update

Pre-Index with Update: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]!**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is
-255 to +255

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x88
0x20008006	0x79
0x20008005	0x6A
0x20008004	0x5B
0x20008003	0x4C
0x20008002	0x3D
0x20008001	0x2E
0x20008000	0x1F

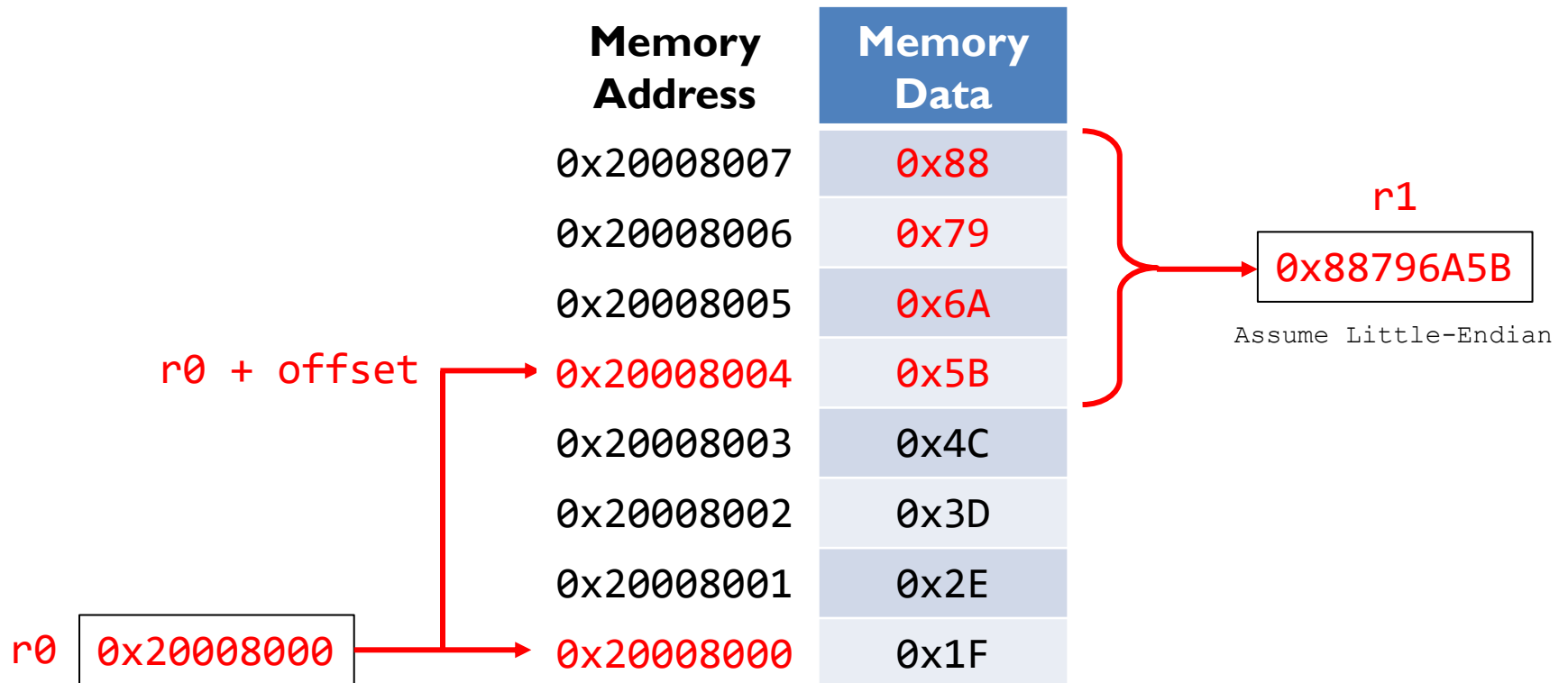
- First, adds the offset (#4) to the base register (r0), then loads from this updated address r0 + 4. Base register r0 is set to r0 + 4 afterwards.
- Example: instruction accesses memory at r0 + 4 = 0x20008004, and also sets r0 to 0x20008004 after execution.

Pre-index

Pre-Index with Update: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]!**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is
-255 to +255

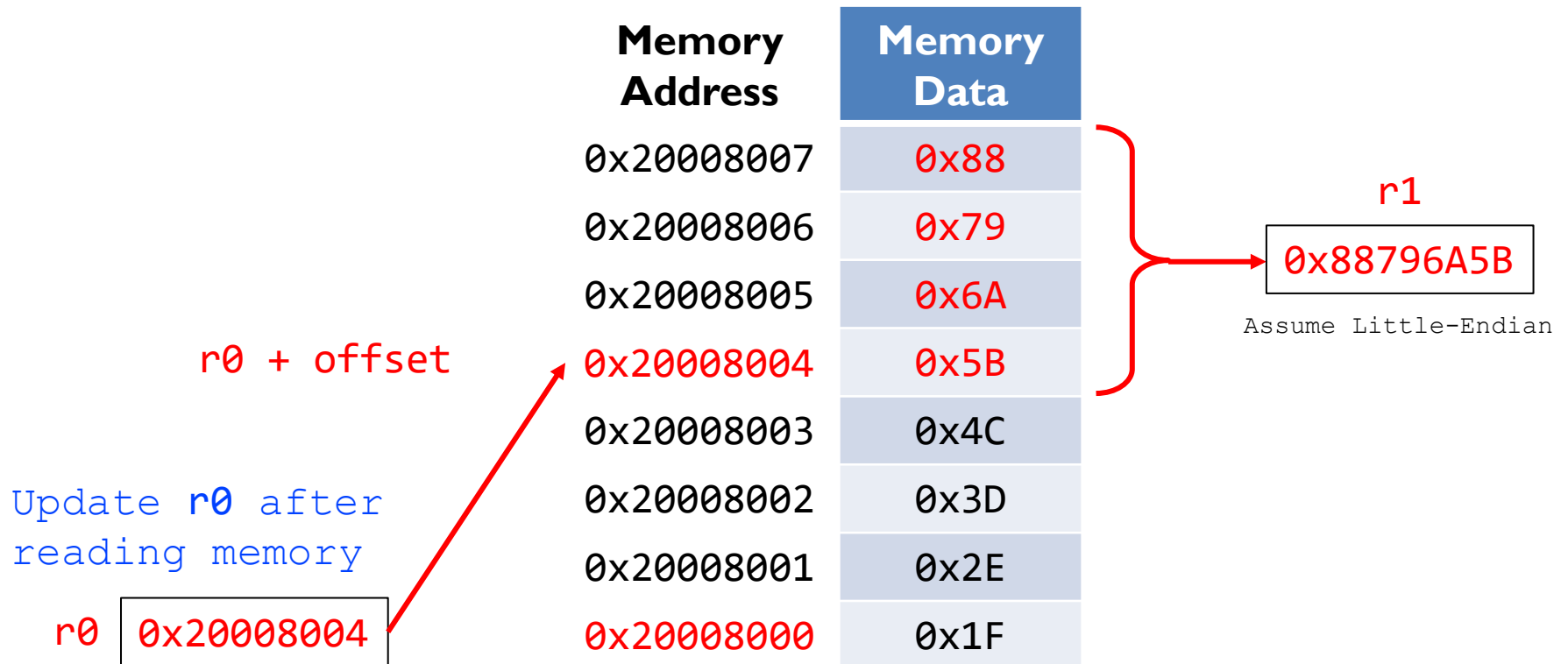


Pre-index

Pre-Index with Update: **LDR r1, [r0, #4]!**

Assume: r0 = 0x20008000

Offset: range is
-255 to +255



Summary of Pre-index and Post-index

Index Format	Example	Equivalent
Pre-index	LDR r1, [r0, #4]	$r1 \leftarrow \text{memory}[r0 + 4]$, r0 is unchanged
Pre-index with update	LDR r1, [r0, #4]!	$r1 \leftarrow \text{memory}[r0 + 4]$ $r0 \leftarrow r0 + 4$
Post-index	LDR r1, [r0], #4	$r1 \leftarrow \text{memory}[r0]$ $r0 \leftarrow r0 + 4$

- ▶ **Pre-index:** use (base + offset), don't change base
Post-index: use base, then change base
Pre-index with update: change base, then use it
- ▶ In ARM Cortex-M/Thumb instruction set, for halfword and signed byte/halfword load/store instructions, the offset is an unsigned 8-bit immediate 0–255, and the U bit selects addition or subtraction, yielding an effective signed range of $[-255, +255]$ around the base register.
- ▶ In ARM (A32) instruction set, for word and unsigned byte LDR/STR, the immediate has an effective signed range of $[-4095, +4095]$

Example (Little-Endian ordering)

LDRH r1, [r0]

; r0 = 0x20008000

r1 before load

0x12345678

r1 after load

**Memory
Address**

0x20008003

0x20008002

0x20008001

0x20008000

**Memory
Data**

0x89

0xAB

0xCD

0xEF

Example ANS (Little-Endian ordering)

LDRH r1, [r0]
; r0 = 0x20008000

r1 before load (r1 is
Overwritten by LDR)

0x12345678

r1 after load

0x0000CDEF

**Memory
Address**

0x20008003

0x20008002

0x20008001

0x20008000

**Memory
Data**

0x89

0xAB

0xCD

0xEF

Example (Endianness does not matter for single byte)

LDRSB r1, [r0]
; r0 = 0x20008000

r1 before load

0x12345678

r1 after load

**Memory
Address**

0x20008003

0x20008002

0x20008001

0x20008000

**Memory
Data**

0x89

0xAB

0xCD

0xEF

Example ANS (Endianness does not matter for single byte)

LDRSB r1, [r0]
; r0 = 0x20008000

r1 before load (r1 is
Overwritten by LDR)

0x12345678

r1 after load

0xFFFFFFFF

**Memory
Address**

0x20008003

0x20008002

0x20008001

0x20008000

**Memory
Data**

0x89

0xAB

0xCD

0xEF

Example (Little-Endian ordering)

STR r1, [r0, #4]

; r0 = 0x20008000, r1=0x76543210

r0 before the store

0x20008000

r0 after the store

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x00
0x20008006	0x00
0x20008005	0x00
0x20008004	0x00
0x20008003	0x00
0x20008002	0x00
0x20008001	0x00
r0 → 0x20008000	0x00

Example ANS (Little-Endian ordering)

STR r1, [r0, #4]

; r0 = 0x20008000, r1=0x76543210

r0 before store

0x20008000

r0 after store

0x20008000

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x76
0x20008006	0x54
0x20008005	0x32
0x20008004	0x10
0x20008003	0x00
0x20008002	0x00
0x20008001	0x00
r0 → 0x20008000	0x00

Example (Little-Endian ordering)

STR r1, [r0], #4

; r0 = 0x20008000, r1=0x76543210

r0 before store

0x20008000

r0 after store

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x00
0x20008006	0x00
0x20008005	0x00
0x20008004	0x00
0x20008003	0x00
0x20008002	0x00
0x20008001	0x00
r0 → 0x20008000	0x00

Example ANS (Little-Endian ordering)

STR r1, [r0], #4

; r0 = 0x20008000, r1=0x76543210

r0 before store

0x20008000

r0 after store

0x20008004

r0 →

**Memory
Address**

0x20008007

0x20008006

0x20008005

0x20008004

0x20008003

0x20008002

0x20008001

0x20008000

**Memory
Data**

0x00

0x00

0x00

0x00

0x76

0x54

0x32

0x10

Example

STR r1, [r0, #4]!

; r0 = 0x20008000, r1=0x76543210

r0 before store

0x20008000

r0 after store

Memory Address	Memory Data
0x20008007	0x00
0x20008006	0x00
0x20008005	0x00
0x20008004	0x00
0x20008003	0x00
0x20008002	0x00
0x20008001	0x00
r0 → 0x20008000	0x00

Example

STR r1, [r0, #4]!

; r0 = 0x20008000, r1=0x76543210

r0 before store

0x20008000

r0 after store

0x20008004

r0 →

**Memory
Address**

0x20008007

0x20008006

0x20008005

0x20008004

0x20008003

0x20008002

0x20008001

0x20008000

**Memory
Data**

0x76

0x54

0x32

0x10

0x00

0x00

0x00

0x00

Addressing Modes for Load/Store Multiple Registers

STMxx rn{!}, {register_list}

LDMxx rn{!}, {register_list}

► xx = IA, IB, DA, or DB

Addressing Modes	Description	Instructions
IA	Increment A fter	STMIA, LDMIA
IB	Increment B efore	STMIB, LDMIB
DA	Decrement A fter	STMDA, LDMDA
DB	Decrement B efore	STMDB, LDMDB

- **IA**: address is incremented by 4 after a word is loaded or stored.
- **IB**: address is incremented by 4 before a word is loaded or stored.
- **DA**: address is decremented by 4 after a word is loaded or stored.
- **DB**: address is decremented by 4 before a word is loaded or stored.

Load/Store Multiple Registers

- ▶ The following are synonyms.
 - ▶ **STM** = **STMIA** (Increment After) = **STM_{EA}** (Empty Ascending)
 - ▶ **LDM** = **LDMIA** (Increment After) = **LDM_{FD}** (Full Descending)
 - ▶ Two independent switches:
 - ▶ Increment or decrement?
 - ▶ Before or after?
- ▶ The order in which registers are listed does not matter
 - ▶ For STM/LDM, the lowest-numbered register is stored/loaded at the lowest memory address.

Store Multiple Registers

STMxx r0!, {r3,r1,r7,r2}

STMIA

Increment After

STMIB

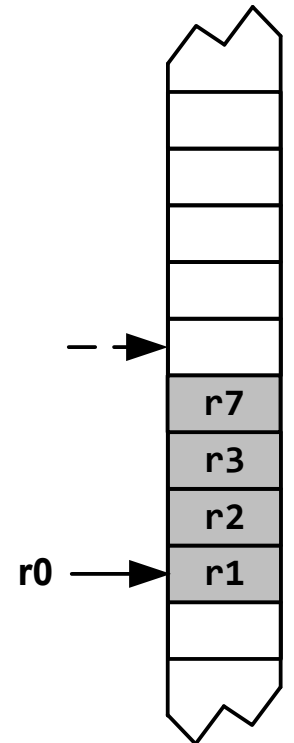
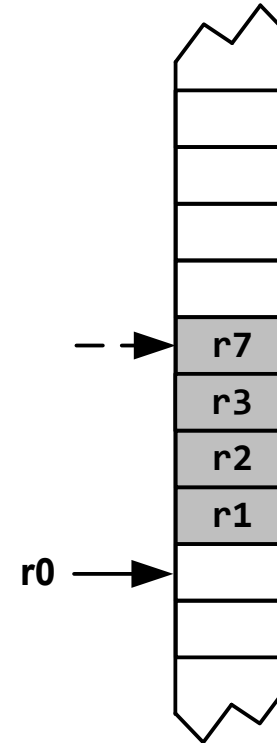
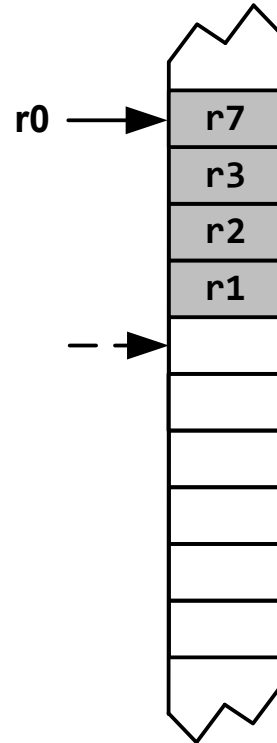
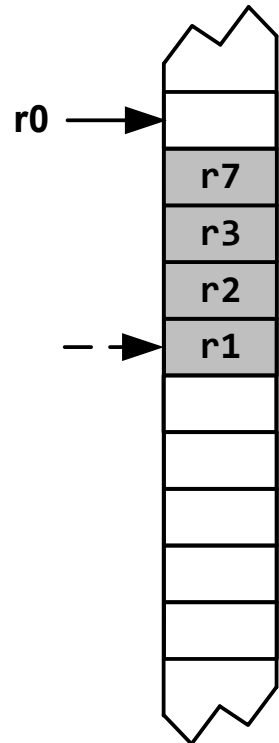
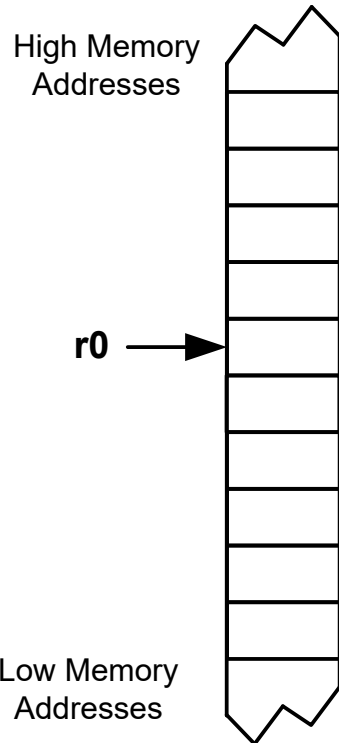
Increment Before

STMDA

Decrement After

STMDB

Decrement Before



Load Multiple Registers

LDMxx r0!, {r3,r1,r7,r2}

LDMIA

Increment After

LDMIB

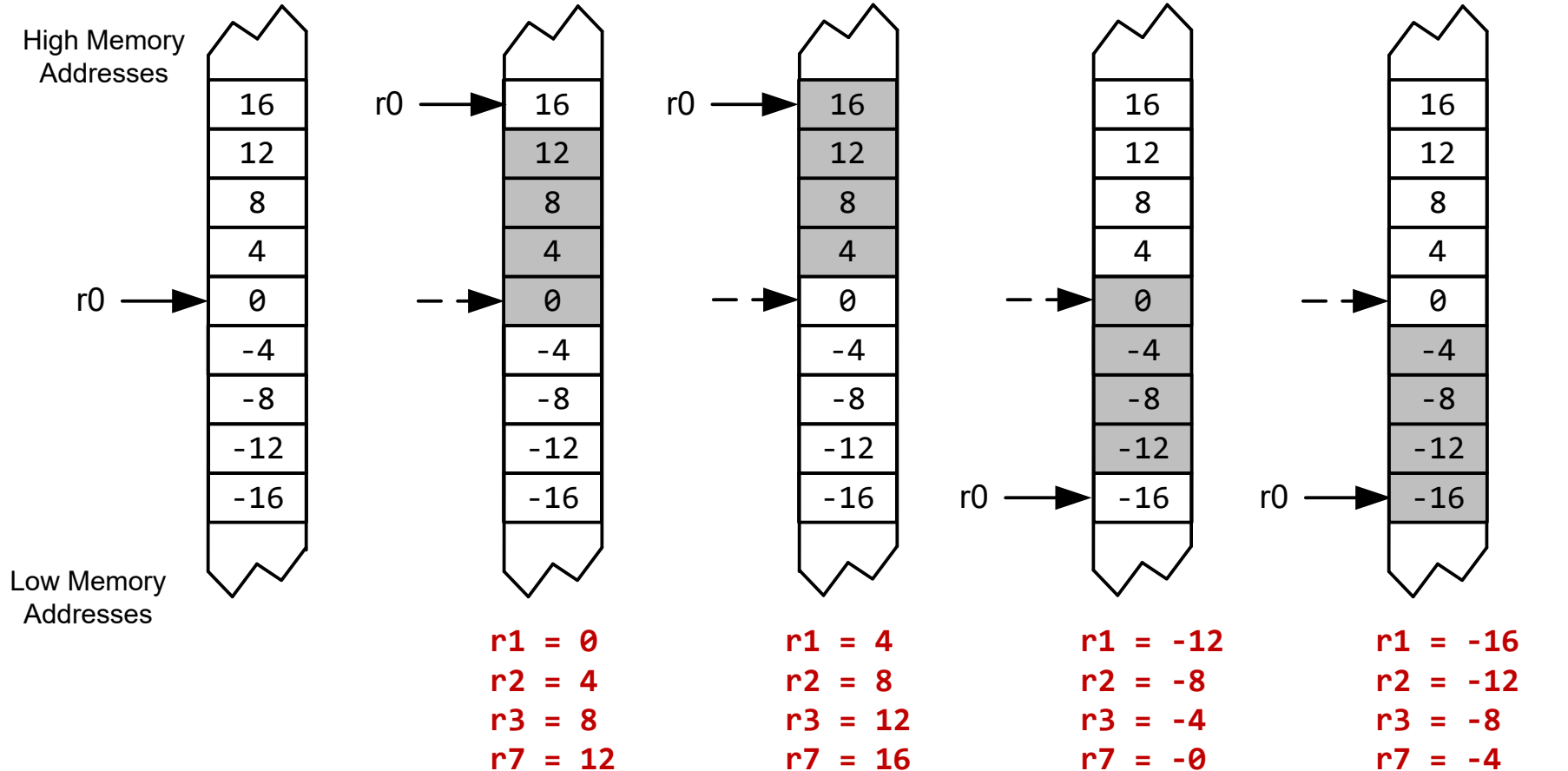
Increment Before

LMDA

Decrement After

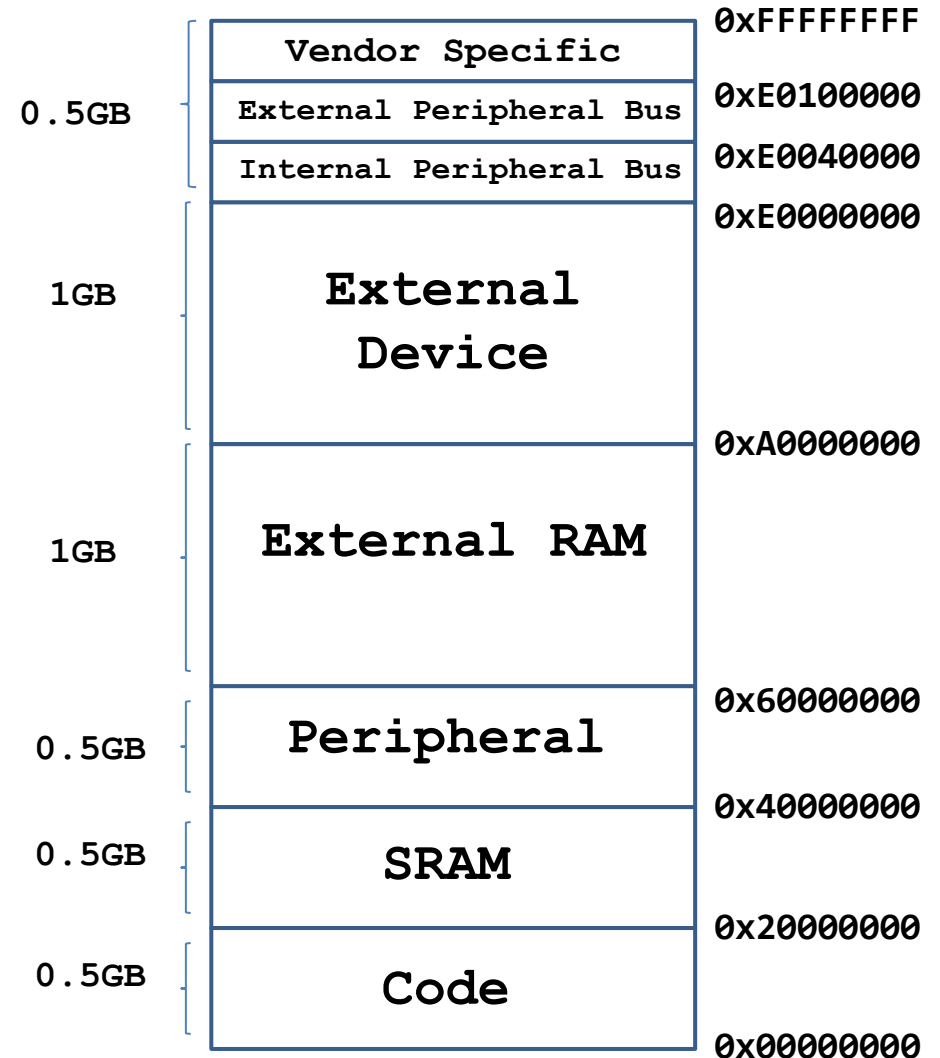
LDMDB

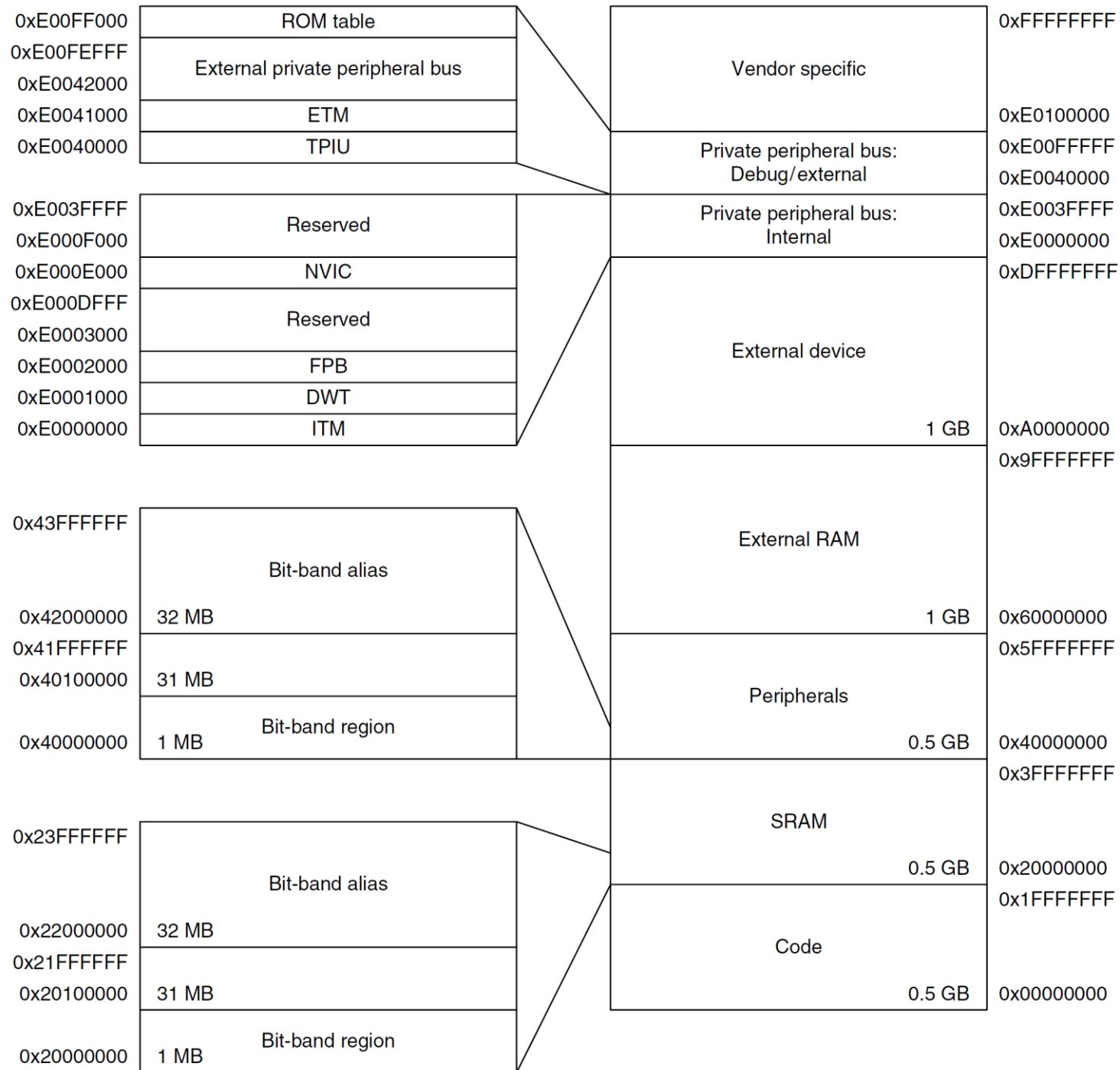
Decrement Before



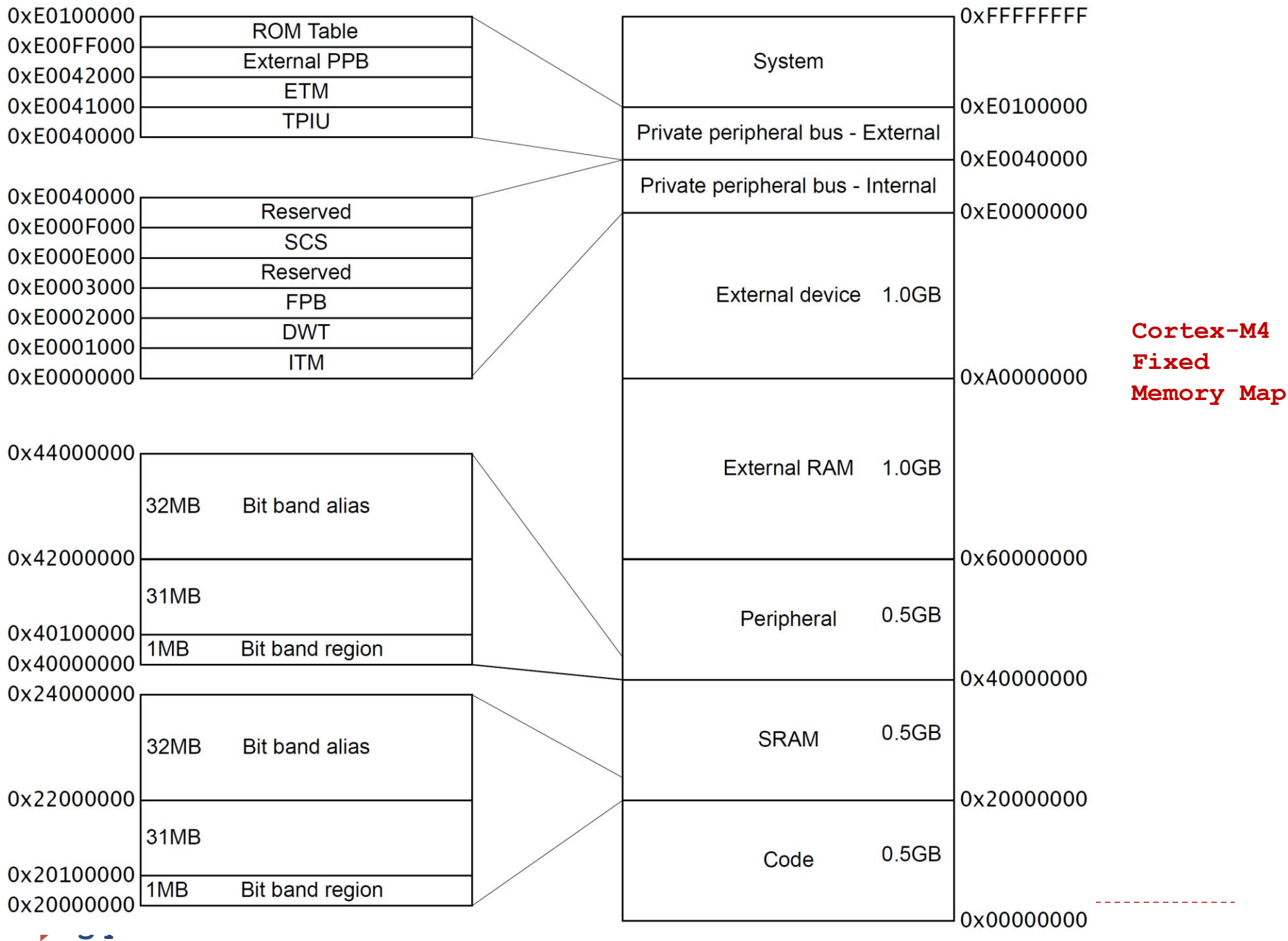
Cortex-M3 & Cortex-M4 Memory Map

- ▶ 32-bit Memory Address
- ▶ 2^{32} bytes of memory space (4 GB)
- ▶ Harvard architecture: physically separated instruction memory and data memory





**Cortex-M3
Fixed
Memory
Map**



Pseudo-instructions

- ▶ **Pseudo instruction**: available to use in an assembly program, but not directly supported by hardware.
- ▶ Pseudo → not real
- ▶ Compilers translate it to one or multiple actual machine instructions
- ▶ Pseudo instructions are provided for the convenience of programmers.

LDR Pseudo-instruction

LDR Rt, =expr

LDR Rt, =label

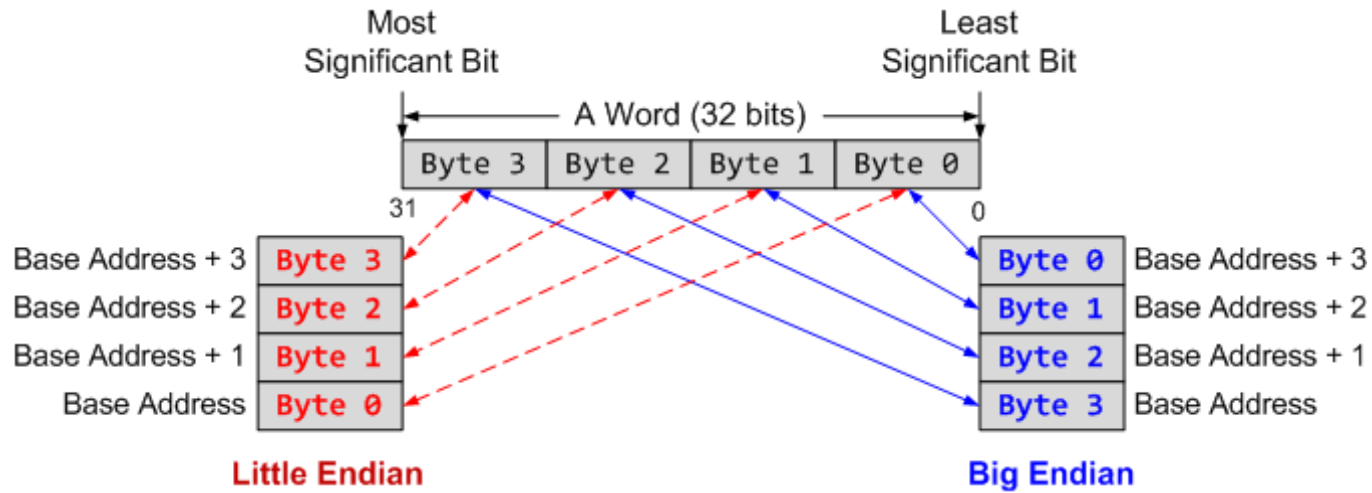
- ▶ If the value of expr can be loaded with **MOV**, **MVN** (16-bit instruction) or **MOVW** (32-bit instruction), the assembler uses that instruction.
 - ▶ **MOV** supports all 8-bit immediate numbers ranging in [0 – 255]. For numbers out of this range, some patterns can be encoded.
- ▶ If a valid **MOV**, **MVN**, **MOVW** instruction cannot be used (due to out of range), or if the **label_expr** syntax is used, the assembler places the constant in a literal pool and generates a **PC-relative LDR** instruction that reads the constant from the literal pool.

```
LDR r1,=0xFF0 ; loads 0xFF0 into R1
                ; => MOV r1,#0xFF0
LDR r2,=0xFFF ; loads 0xFFF into R2
                ; => MOVW r2, #0xFFF
LDR r3,=array ; loads the address of array into R3
                ; => LDR r3,[pc, offset_to_litpool]
                ; ...
                ; litpool DCD array
```

Software uses this pseudo instruction to set a register to some value without worrying about the size of the value.

Summary

- ▶ Memory address is always in terms of bytes.
- ▶ How data is organized in memory?



- ▶ How data is addressed?

Addressing Format	Example	Equivalent
Pre-index	<code>LDR r1, [r0, #4]</code>	$r1 \leftarrow \text{memory}[r0 + 4]$, $r0$ is unchanged
Pre-index with update	<code>LDR r1, [r0, #4]!</code>	$r1 \leftarrow \text{memory}[r0 + 4]$ $r0 \leftarrow r0 + 4$
Post-Index	<code>LDR r1, [r0], #4</code>	$r1 \leftarrow \text{memory}[r0]$ $r0 \leftarrow r0 + 4$

References

- ▶ Lecture 22. Big-Endian and Little-Endian
 - ▶ https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TI C9Kj_78ek&list=PLRJhV4hUhlymmp5CCeIFPyxbknsdcXCc8&index=22
- ▶ Lecture 23. Load and Store Instructions
 - ▶ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CtfV3HsHwk4&list=PLRJhV4hUhlymmp5CCeIFPyxbknsdcXCc8&index=23>
- ▶ Lecture 24. Addressing mode: pre-index, post-index, and pre-index with update
 - ▶ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zgkxPdPkxa8&list=PLRJhV4hUhlymmp5CCeIFPyxbknsdcXCc8&index=24>
- ▶ ARM Instruction Set - Stack Instructions STMFD, STMFA , STMED, STMEA, Vishal Gaikwad
 - ▶ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H4xoaOINSJo>